

IMPORTANCE Of DRONES And TYPES Of DRONES For WILDLIFE MONITORING

Drones, or unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), are rapidly changing the face of wildlife and conservation industry. They have the potential to revolutionise conservation and spatial ecology. At the core of conservation is the monitoring of species' population and their habitats



DR ANAND NAYYAR
is PhD in wireless sensor networks and swarms intelligence. He works at Duy Tan University, Vietnam. He loves to explore open source technologies, IoT, cloud computing, deep learning, and cyber security



A drone used for wildlife monitoring (Source: www.airbornedrones.co)



DR MAGESH KASTHURI
is a senior distinguished member of the technical staff and principal consultant at Wipro Ltd. This article expresses his views and not that of Wipro

Traditional approaches and devices used for wildlife monitoring have been high-cost, sometimes inefficient and not so practical when used in remote or rough terrain areas. A major issue in monitoring systems is that the species can feel threatened and attack the monitoring devices and personnel, which could potentially impact the monitoring activities and lead to time and money wastage.

Drones fitted with thermal cameras can circumvent these problems and ob-

tain accurate data and high-resolution images in a better, faster, cheaper, and safer manner. The use of drones in conservation sector need not be limited to monitoring and can be extended to management, technical services, eco-tourism marketing, law enforcement, anti-poaching, and search-and-rescue efforts.

Drone users categorised as ecologists or hobbyists need to understand the anatomy of eco-system that they handle. During wildlife monitoring, animals may not get directly disturbed but birds can get